

Cooperation of Muslim & Christian Philosophers of 4th century A.H/11th A.D for Establishment of an ethical system

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Among the centuries of Islamic calendar, perhaps the most brilliant and attractive is the 4th Islamic century/ 11th Christian one, which represents the free and tolerant spirit of Islamic civilisation as well as its moral, humanistic and rational aspect.

The characteristics of this brilliant period are as follows:

1. Cultural pluralism and religious tolerance;
2. Philosophical approach not in scholastic form, but in problem oriented one with practical aim, far away from abstract topics, and with religious tendency;
3. Moderate humanism with emphasis on self knowledge mostly in literal type of humanism: to respect for reason, tendency for ancient knowledge, emphasis on the fraternity and friendship, variety of philosophical tendencies, to believe in relationships of humankind, and love to all of humans, not only the countrymen or coreligionists.
4. To pay high attention to the ethics.

These approaches and achievements were produced and presented more in the circles and meetings instead of schools or official programs. This period is famous for its circles moderated sometimes by ministers and some other times by scholars especially philosophers and theologians.

One of the most famous circles of that time is the circle of yahya/John bin adiyy, the jacobian Christian, which included Muslim disciples and Christian ones. The standard book of ethic in Islamic tradition is tahzib al-akhlagh (purification of the morals), written by Iranian Shi'ite philosopher, Abu Ali Misawayh who is one of the members of that circle.

But the first ethical book which is written under the title of Tahzib Al-Akhlagh is created by the head of that circle, Yahya bin 'Adi. He himself was influenced by his master, Al-Farabi (Alpharabius) who is considered as the founder of Islamic philosophy including philosophical ethics.

According to these records, we can speak of a moral philosophical system which couples of philosophers, Muslims and Christians contributed in its production.

This article aims to discover and show the characteristics of this ethical system which will improve the common features of ethics in Islam and Christianity from philosophical point of view and will focus on the moral righteousness(moderation) which associated with the concept of rationality, as it accepted in Islamic tradition when Imam Ali(the first of Imams of Twelvers Shi'ite Muslim) says that:

You can't find the ignorant(who doesn't act reasonably) except deviated from the righteousness.